

Description	Bull Market, Up Breakout	Bear Market, Up Breakout	Bull Market, Down Breakout	Bear Market, Down Breakout
Days to ultimate high or low	253	91	56	37
How many change trend?	52%	41%	23%	45%

Statistics

[Table 11.2](#) shows general statistics for this chart pattern.

Number found. I uncovered 2,424 broadening tops in data from July 1991 to November 2019 in 873 stocks. Not all stocks covered the entire time, and some of them no longer trade.

Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence. By definition, since we are dealing with a top, an upward breakout is a continuation and a downward breakout means a reversal of the prevailing upward trend.

Average rise or decline. I compared the average rise or decline with the average for all chart pattern types and found that the broadening top underperforms in all market conditions (bull/bear) and breakout directions, despite what you see in the table.

Standard & Poor's 500 change. Notice how the general market helped or hindered price. The numbers, when compared to the average rise or decline, suggest trading with the market trend (bull market, upward breakouts and bear market, downward breakouts) for the best performance. This makes intuitive sense.

Days to ultimate high or low. The time it takes price to rise to the ultimate high or sink to the ultimate low varies from 253 days (about 8.5 months) to 37 (5 weeks).

I compared the average speed of price for upward versus downward breakouts in bull markets. The decline should have taken 79 days, but the average is 56 as shown in the table. Thus, price drops faster than it rises. In